Answers and talk notes

Estimate the Percent of a Number

What your student is learning

Tonight we estimate a percent of a number by rounding to friendly values first — and then we explain whether the estimate runs a bit high or a bit low.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **D.** 20%. 18% is closest to the benchmark 20%.
2. **B.** 400. 412 is close to 400, and 400 is easy to work with.
3. **A.** 30. 10% is one tenth, so 300 ÷ 10 = 30.
4. **C.** 80. 20% is two groups of 10%, so 40 × 2 = 80.
5. **D.** About 40. About 40: round 198 to 200. 10% of 200 is 20, so 20% is double that.
6. **B.** A little high, because 80 is more than 78. A little high, because 80 is more than 78. Rounding the amount up makes the estimate a bit bigger.

Talk about it

Which way did you round, and does your estimate run a little high or a little low?

Home mission

Count the cans or boxes in a kitchen cabinet. Round the count to a friendly number. Estimate 20% of it. Does your estimate run high or low?

When they are stuck, ask

- What is 10% of that number?
- What friendly percent is this one close to?
- Which way did you round, and what does that do to the estimate?

Try not to say

- Estimating means just guessing a number.
- Use a calculator, the exact answer is easier.
- The whole is always the first number in the problem.